



Mehrdad Baratian

Ph.D. Candidate

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EDUCATION

- **Tulane University** 2021-present
*Ph.D. Candidate in **Econometrics and Quantitative Economics*** New Orleans, LA.
Specializations: Applied Microeconomics, Health Economics, Innovation
- **Tulane University** 2021-2023
*Master in **Econometrics and Quantitative Economics*** New Orleans, LA.
Specializations: Applied Microeconomics
- **Tehran Polytechnic** 2016-2018
*Master of Science: **Business Administration*** Tehran
Graduated Top 3 in Class
- **University of Isfahan** 2010-2015
*Bachelor of Science: **Mechanical Engineering*** Isfahan
Achieved a Top 1% Ranking in the National University Entrance Exam

FIELDS

Health Economics, Innovation, Labor Economics

WORKING PAPERS

- **The Shadow Price of Parental Time: Long-Run Human Capital Effects of the “Work-First” Welfare Transition** *Job Market Paper*
 - **Abstract:** The 1990s shift from entitlement-based cash assistance to “work-first” welfare pulled millions of low-income mothers into employment, changing the time environment of early childhood for a generation of children. I ask how exposure to this transition between conception and age five affects those children’s outcomes in adulthood. Using the Panel Study of Income Dynamics and children’s state of birth, I measure each child’s exposure as the share of a 69-month window spent under AFDC waivers (1992–1996) or TANF (1996–1997), and I estimate its long-run effect with a staggered difference-in-differences design in the spirit of Hoynes, Schanzenbach, and Almond (2016). Adults who spent more of early childhood under the reform are substantially more likely to be employed, a result that holds under stacked difference-in-differences, the Callaway–Sant’Anna estimator, wild cluster bootstrap inference, and Romano–Wolf correction for multiple testing. What moves the outcome is the duration of exposure rather than the harshness of a state’s rules: sanction severity, time limits, and work-requirement stringency show no gradient. The employment gain does not extend to health, where the estimates are sensitive to the estimator and lean negative. These patterns are consistent with a reform that raised the shadow price of parental time at home, trading gains in later labor-market attachment against investment in early childhood.
- **Shocks, Reallocation, and the Direction of Innovation: The Case of COVID-19** *Working Paper*
 - Methods: NLP topic clustering of PubMed research papers (2017–2022); interrupted time series; stacked event-study Difference-in-Differences
 - Finding: Major shocks reallocate research effort across scientific fields, with substitution away from shock-distant areas and complementary acceleration in method- and platform-adjacent fields.
- **SNAP Generosity and Mental Health** *Working Paper*
 - Methods: Difference-in-Differences; dose–response Difference-in-Differences; XGBoost machine learning for data imputation
 - Finding: SNAP allotments support mental health during economic hardship, with effects emerging beyond a minimum benefit threshold.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Research & Teaching Assistant, Tulane University** 2022-present
 - Courses: Econometrics II (Ph.D. Level); Machine Learning and Econometrics; Intermediate Microeconomics; Health Economics; Introduction to Macroeconomics; Introduction to Microeconomics.
- **Teaching Assistant — Strategic Management, Tehran Polytechnic** Spring 2018
 - Course: Strategic Management.

AWARDS

- APPAM Excellence, Equity and Inclusion Student Fellowship *2026–2027*
- Cato University Summer Term II (Full Scholarship), Cato Institute *August 2026*
- J.E. Land Fund for School of Liberal Arts Graduate Student Travel *July 2026*
- Graduate Student Summer Research Award, Tulane University *June 2024, May 2025*
- Graduate Studies Student Association Travel Award, Tulane University *May 2024*
- Joachim-Herz Foundation Award *June 2024*
- Connolly Alexander Institute for Data Science Research Grant Award *June 2024, April 2025*

CONFERENCE AND PRESENTATION

- **First Author Presenter**
 - Southern Economic Association (SEA) | Houston, TX. *November 2026*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Boston, MA. *November 2026*
 - American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) | Minneapolis, MN. *June 2026*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Seattle, WA. *Fall 2025*
 - Southern Economic Association (SEA) | Tampa, FL. *Fall 2025*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Washington, D.C. *Fall 2024*
 - Essen Economics of Mental Health Workshop, CINCH - Health Economics Research Center | Universität Duisburg-Essen. Minneapolis, MN. *August 2024*
 - American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) | San Diego, CA. *June 2024*

PEER REVIEW SERVICE

- **Conference Referee**
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference *Fall 2025*
- **Journal Referee**
 - Journal of Data Analytics and Intelligent Decision-Making *Fall 2025*

WORKING EXPERIENCE

- **Statistical Research Consultant, CAIDS, Tulane University:** *Fall 2026*
 - Consult with Tulane faculty, staff, and student researchers at the Connolly Alexander Institute for Data Science on statistical methodology, research design, and analysis, with support in Python, R, and Stata.
- **Leadership Role at Tulane University:** *2022-2024*
 - Vice President, Graduate Student Association—led cross-council initiatives; managed budgets; university liaison.
- **Negin Bazr Co.** *2018-2021*
 - Product Marketing Manager, Market Researcher.
 - Developed and demonstrated advanced teamwork, decision-making, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills within the private sector, contributing to successful project outcomes and driving organizational efficiency.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Causal Inference:** Difference-in-Differences; Regression Discontinuity; Matching; Instrumental Variables
- **Quantitative Methods:** Econometric Modeling; Predictive Analytics; Deep Learning; Data Analysis
- **Deep Learning / NLP:** Neural Networks; BERT models; TF-IDF; Clustering; Classification
- **Programming:** Python; Stata; SQL
- **Computing:** Amazon Web Services (AWS); Tulane University High-Performance Computing (Cypress)
- **Languages:** English; Farsi

REFERENCES

1- Kevin Callison Associate Professor (Dissertation Chair) Department of Health Policy and Management Tulane University Email: kcallison@tulane.edu Phone: (614) 989-1764	2- Katy Bergstrom Assistant Professor Department of Economics Tulane University Email: kbergstrom@tulane.edu	3- Jonathan Holmes Assistant Professor Department of Economics Tulane University Email: jholmes13@tulane.edu
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